TEXORA · COURSE NOTES · LECTURE SHEET

Significance of Communication

Why communication matters — its place in management, in coordination and decision-making, in industrial relations, and in a professional's career.

HUM-1107 · COMMUNICATIVE ENGLISH · TOPIC 4 · LEVEL 1 TERM 1

1. The management claim

A classic observation of management studies: managers spend the great majority of their working time communicating — studies of managerial work commonly put it at 70–90% of the day, divided among meetings, calls, correspondence, reports and floor conversation. This is not overhead on the real work; in a factory, communication *is* the mechanism of the real work. Materials and machines are coordinated by nothing else: the yarn does not know which loom it is destined for until somebody's message tells the store, the warping section and the weaving shed, in the right order, with the right numbers.

2. The main heads of significance

AREA	WHAT COMMUNICATION DOES THERE
Basis of coordination	Aligns the efforts of departments and individuals toward common targets — production, quality and delivery schedules exist only as communicated agreements.
Foundation of decision-making	Decisions are only as good as the information reaching the decider; upward communication carries the facts, downward communication carries the decision back into action.
Smooth and efficient working	Clear instructions prevent idle machines, wrong materials and duplicated effort; misunderstandings are among the most expensive industrial accidents that leave no injury.
Motivation and morale	People work better when they know what is happening and why; recognition, explanation and being listened to are communicated — silence from management is also a message, and rarely a good one.
Industrial relations	Most disputes are born in misunderstanding; functioning grievance channels and honest negotiation are communication systems before they are legal ones.

Leadership and supervision	Leadership is exercised almost entirely through communication — directing, persuading, correcting, encouraging.
External relations	Buyers, suppliers, banks, regulators and the public meet the organisation through its letters, reports and representatives; the firm’s image is a communication product.
Change and innovation	New methods, new machines and new targets are adopted only when explained persuasively; resistance to change is usually resistance to how it was communicated.

3. The cost side: what poor communication does

The negative of the picture is equally examinable: wrong shades dyed and wrong counts spun because an instruction was ambiguous; shipments missed because a change of date lived in one department’s inbox; accidents where a warning was never passed; disputes escalating because the grievance channel was a rumour. Quality systems make the point formally: ISO-style documentation is an organisation deciding that vital communication will be written, versioned and retrievable rather than remembered — significance, institutionalised.

4. Significance for the individual professional

For the student, the translation is direct: technical knowledge earns an engineer the right to be heard, but communication skill decides how far the hearing goes. Interviews are communication examinations; reports are how absent superiors judge present work; the buyer-facing roles of merchandising and marketing — the textile industry’s best-paid communication jobs — are this course’s syllabus with salaries attached. The engineer who writes a clear report and speaks a clear sentence is not decorating the profession; he is practising its central act.

5. Glossary — key terms of this topic

TERM	MEANING
Coordination	The alignment of separate efforts toward a common goal; achieved through communication.
Morale	The confidence and willingness of a workforce, strongly shaped by how it is communicated with.
Industrial relations	The relations between management and workers, including negotiation and grievance handling.

Grievance channel	The recognised route by which a worker’s complaint travels to someone who can act on it.
Documentation	Communication fixed in controlled written form (procedures, specifications, records).

6. Key points and summary

- Communication is the operating system of management: coordination, decisions, efficiency, motivation, relations and change all run on it, and managers spend most of their day inside it.
- Its absence has measurable industrial costs — errors, disputes, missed shipments — which quality systems answer with controlled documentation.
- For the individual, communicative competence is career capital: interviews, reports and buyer relations all examine it directly.

7. Practice

Answer in your own words; brief model answers follow.

1. Explain, with one factory example, the statement “communication is the basis of coordination.”
2. How does communication serve decision-making in both directions of flow?
3. A mill’s management communicates targets but never reasons or results. Predict two effects on morale and name the significance head involved.
4. “Most industrial disputes are communication failures before they are anything else.” Argue for or against, using the grievance-channel idea.
5. Connect ISO-style documentation to the significance of communication — what failure does each controlled document prevent?
6. An engineer says, “My work should speak for itself; writing reports is not real engineering.” Answer him from this topic’s material.
7. List the eight heads of significance from §2 and mark the two you judge most important for a dyeing section, with reasons.

Answer key

1. Coordination means separate sections acting in the right order on the same job. Example: a weaving order succeeds only if the communicated schedule tells the store to issue the count, warping to prepare the beam and the shed to mount it — three efforts aligned by messages alone.
2. Upward flow brings the decider facts (production figures, faults, market reports); downward flow converts the decision into instructions that reach everyone who must act. A failure in either direction

— blind decisions or unactioned ones — breaks the cycle.

3. Workers feel treated as instruments; rumours fill the vacuum (morale falls) and unexplained targets are resisted or gamed (motivation suffers). Head: motivation and morale — with industrial relations likely to follow.
4. For: a grievance heard early through a working channel is a conversation; unheard, it becomes a rumour, then a collective dispute — the escalation is a sequence of failed communications. (A balanced answer may add that some disputes have genuine material causes — but even those are settled, or worsened, at a negotiating table.)
5. Each controlled document fixes one vital message — the specification, the method, the limit — in a single current version, preventing the classic failures: two sections working from different remembered versions, and knowledge vanishing when one employee is absent.
6. His superiors and buyers mostly meet his work through his reports — unwritten work is invisible work. Inside the plant, his instructions and handovers are communication too; weak writing turns good engineering into wrong production. Communication is not decoration on the work; it is how the work reaches anyone else.
7. Any two defended. Typical dyeing answer: smooth and efficient working (recipes, shade standards and timing must be unambiguous — the costliest errors are shade errors) and basis of coordination (preparation, dyeing, finishing and quality must act in sequence on the same lot).
